Brendan Boyce

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Computer Science student at the University of Nottingham with experience and great grades in artificial intelligence and software engineering, my ambition is to land a job in either a general software engineering role to further expand my skill set or to work with data and build predictive models in the financial sector.

Education

BSc Computer Science, University of Nottingham Expected Result 2:1 **2023 - Present**

Developed skills in C programming, algorithm design, and debugging. From the Programming Algorithms module, I gained skills in how to think about solving problems and furthered my understanding of algorithmic efficiency through implementing and optimizing various commonly used algorithms. Achieving a 2:1.

Software engineering taught me that building software wasn't just about programming skills, it requires good teamwork. In the Introduction to Software Engineering module, I took last year, I collaborated with 4 other people with different skill sets to complete a piece of software. Here I was introduced to the art of requirements gathering and analysis, where we had to come up with user stories for the software and use Visual Paradigm to create UML diagrams to really understand what the client wanted and how we would methodically go about completing this software. Once this was complete, we were tasked with fixing buggy code written in Java and testing our new methods with JUnit to ensure the functions were working as they should be. To coordinate our efforts, we had to become very comfortable with Git and version control as we were all working on the same few classes in the software. I achieved a 2:1 in this module.

Low-level programming is also a keen interest of mine, my passion for it grew in my first year while taking the Systems and Architecture module where we covered programming in ARM assembly language and how computers work as well as how computers communicate over the internet. This module made me appreciate programming in a higher-level language more, however stripping away all of the abstraction and really squeezing the performance out of my program was a very interesting experience. I achieved a first in this module.

Experience with AI. I demonstrated proficiency in the Fundamentals of Artificial Intelligence when handling large data sets using Python by predicting film revenue based on many variables provided, effectively using techniques such as data preprocessing and feature selection to achieve accurate model predictions with tools such as linear regression for supervised learning.

St Michael's Catholic High School **2015 - 2022**
A-Levels: Mathematics (B), Physics (C), Business (C)
10 GCSEs: 7 in maths, 7 in physics, 6 in everything else.

Additional Experience

GetJar Operative, Barking Gascoigne estate phase 2

- In my first real job, we were developing blocks of flats in Barking. I adapted to this new environment well, many of my coworkers struggled to speak English. Despite this communication breakdown, we were able to overcome this language barrier, understanding and fulfilling the needs of the clients.

GetJar Operative, groundworker and striker, London Bridge, The Chapter

- Problem-solving: I switched roles from groundwork to striking concrete formwork which can be dangerous as hazards include falling from height and falling objects. I collaborated with my team to minimise these risks as much as possible by outlining the HSE guidelines for our activities, consequently, there were no accidents when I was working there.

GetJar Operative, striker, Barking Gascoigne estate phase 3

- Leadership: This role isn't something typically taught in college or university, so when new employees join the company, they require on-the-job training. A new employee joined Getjar, and the foreman on site assigned him to work with. I realised this man had no prior construction experience, so I thought he was a liability to our team, however, I took a proactive yet precautionary approach to train him. He was very eager to work as much as possible and prove himself in the company, however, I could see team members were unsatisfied with this performance as he was getting in the way of their work and was clumsy at times. A lesson I learned from him was sometimes you need to take a step back in a project and let the more competent members of the teamwork to ensure the client's needs are met without issues. I explained this to him so he took a step back and would watch. Over time he became more and more involved in our work until he could work in the team seamlessly. He is still employed at the company at a different site, he is seen as a resourceful hardworking man and is a great addition to the workforce.

Positions of Responsibility

GCSE Mathematics Tutor, ST Michael's Catholic Highschool **2020-2022**

- I am very passionate about mathematics, so I inspired students to engage with the subject and achieve their academic goals.
- I also developed strong communication skills by simplifying complex mathematical concepts and tailoring lessons to individual learning needs.
- I demonstrated leadership and problem-solving abilities by guiding students through challenges and fostering independent analytical thinking.

Technical Skills

- Python
- C
- ARM Assembly
- Java
- HTML
- CSS